

There was no further clarification in the survey to specify if the visits to the doctor were in person or online. We now acknowledge this as a limitations that our survey did not specifically ask about virtual or in-person visits, in Methods section: ***“The questions did not differentiate between virtual and in-person care”*** (Methods, page 6).

Consider clarifying the language around “see a doctor” and indicate whether it was only limited to in-person consultations.

This was not clarified in the survey, so we are unable to further address this in the study.

I was surprised that the results section did not include any numbers.

We agree! The journal website indicates that they numbers should be in the tables and not repeated in the text but after referring to other published papers we have now added some numbers throughout the results section.

Household income was retrieved from data cycle 2015-2018. Yet, it does not reflect income in 2020, particularly since many individuals have lost their jobs during the pandemic.

Unfortunately, participants were not asked again for their household income in the COVID-19 Questionnaire study. This limitation has been now described, *“Although we examined several predictors, including pre-pandemic unmet healthcare needs, some of the data had been collected in FUP1 and may not reflect the participants’ current situation”* (Interpretation, 10)

The guidelines for COVID-19 testing eligibility kept evolving over time and across provinces. How do you think this has affected your results about barriers in accessing COVID-19 testing?

This has been added as a limitation, *“The fluctuations in case counts, public health restrictions and testing guidelines across time and regions made it difficult to describe the reasons behind unmet needs”* (Interpretation, page 10).

The authors stated that “Ontario and BC residents reported higher levels of unmet needs given the high case counts in the province.” If authors made such inference based on the first nine months of the pandemic, this statement is not accurate since the caseload in BC was relatively more minor compared to Ontario and other provinces.

This statement has been deleted. Instead, a sentence describing the limitations of individually discussing the provinces, *“The fluctuations in case counts and testing guidelines across time and regions made it difficult to describe the reasons behind unmet needs”* (Interpretation, page 10).

Typos in SARS=CoV-2, Cis (as in confidence intervals)

Amended, thank you!

In the methods section, add a reference for the use of VIF

As the variation inflation factors were not reported in the results section, this line was cut from the methods section.